

ServiceNow ITSM

Incident Management & Service Operations Lab

Platform: ServiceNow practice/developer environment

Scope: ITSM incident lifecycle, SLA tracking, knowledge management, escalation, and reporting

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1. Executive Summary

This project demonstrates practical ServiceNow IT Service Management (ITSM) workflows in a controlled practice/developer environment. The lab simulates common service desk and IT support activities, including incident creation, categorization, impact and urgency assessment, priority handling, assignment, troubleshooting documentation, resolution, reopening, escalation, SLA review, knowledge article creation, and operational reporting.

Five incident scenarios represent realistic support requests: corporate VPN connectivity, account lockout, Microsoft Outlook failure, internal website access, and an external monitor issue. A recurring Outlook incident was also reopened and reassigned to a specialist support group with documented work notes.

2. Project Objectives

- Practice the complete ServiceNow incident lifecycle from logging through resolution.
- Understand category, subcategory, impact, urgency, and priority for incident triage.
- Use assignment groups and assignees to route incidents to appropriate support teams.
- Document troubleshooting using descriptions, work notes, customer-visible comments, and resolution notes.
- Practice reopening and escalating a recurring incident to a specialist team.
- Review Task SLA information and understand resolution targets.
- Create a reusable troubleshooting knowledge article.
- Build incident reports grouped by category, priority, and state.

3. Environment and Tools

Component	Use in Project
ServiceNow	ITSM incident, knowledge, SLA, and reporting workflows
Incident Management	Create, classify, assign, update, resolve, reopen, and escalate incidents
Knowledge Management	Create a structured VPN troubleshooting knowledge article
Task SLA	Review resolution SLA status and business time information
Reports	Visualize incidents by category, priority, and state

4. Incident Scenarios

Incident	Scenario	Category	Priority	Outcome
INC0010001	Unable to connect to corporate VPN	Network / VPN	4 - Low	Resolved
INC0010002	Employee account locked after multiple failed login attempts	Password Reset	4 - Low	Resolved
INC0010003	Microsoft Outlook fails to open on employee laptop	Software / Email	3 - Moderate	Reopened / escalated
INC0010004	Unable to access internal company website	Network	3 - Moderate	Resolved
INC0010005	Employee laptop is not connecting to external monitor	Hardware	3 - Moderate	Resolved

5. Incident Management Workflow

5.1 Incident Logging and Classification

Each scenario was recorded with a caller, short description, detailed description, category or subcategory, channel, impact, urgency, assignment group, and where available an individual assignee. This simulates the information a service desk analyst records when a user reports an issue.

5.2 Priority and Assignment

Impact and urgency values were used to support prioritization. Incidents were routed to appropriate support groups such as Network, Hardware, Help Desk, and Software. Assignment demonstrates ownership and provides a clear path for troubleshooting and escalation.

5.3 Troubleshooting and Resolution

Resolution notes were used to record the action that restored service. For the VPN scenario, cached credentials were cleared and the user re-authenticated with the current account password. The record documents that VPN connectivity and access to internal resources were restored.

5.4 Reopening and Escalation

The Outlook incident was intentionally reopened to simulate a problem returning after an initial resolution. It was returned to In Progress, reassigned from the Help Desk to the Software support group, assigned to a specialist, and supported with internal work notes explaining the reason for escalation.

6. SLA Tracking

The project includes review of a Priority 3 resolution SLA. The Task SLA view exposes the SLA definition, target, stage, business time remaining, elapsed time, elapsed percentage, and timing information. This demonstrates awareness that IT support work is performed against service targets.

7. Knowledge Management

A knowledge article titled 'Troubleshooting Corporate VPN Connection Issues' was created under the IT/Security knowledge structure. It includes a purpose statement, common symptoms, eight troubleshooting steps, resolution guidance, and escalation criteria.

8. Reporting and Analytics

Three ServiceNow reports were configured to analyze incident data: incidents by category, incidents by priority, and incidents by state. These demonstrate basic operational reporting and the ability to convert ticket data into useful service-management information.

9. Skills Demonstrated

- ServiceNow ITSM and Incident Management
- Incident logging, categorization, and prioritization
- Impact and urgency assessment
- Assignment groups and analyst assignment
- Troubleshooting documentation
- Work notes and customer-visible communication
- Resolution documentation
- Incident reopening, reassignment, and escalation
- Task SLA awareness
- Knowledge article creation
- Reporting by category, priority, and state
- Service desk workflow and support ownership

10. Key Outcomes

The lab provides end-to-end evidence of ServiceNow usage beyond basic ticket creation. It demonstrates the relationship between incident data, support ownership, troubleshooting records, SLA targets, reusable knowledge, and reporting.

This project was completed in a practice/developer environment using simulated incidents and example users. It should be presented as hands-on lab experience rather than production or professional ServiceNow experience.

11. Screenshot Evidence

The following screenshots document the main workflows completed during the project.

11.1 Incident Management Overview

All > Active = true											
☐	Number	Opened	Short description	Caller	Priority	State	Category	Assignment group	Assigned to	Updated	Updated by
	INC0010005	2026-08-19 03:43:28	Employee laptop is not connecting to external monitor	Amelia Caputo	3 - Moderate	Resolved	Hardware	Hardware	Beth Anglin	2026-08-19 03:59:24	admin
	INC0010004	2026-08-19 03:29:06	Unable to access internal company website	Andrew Jackson	3 - Moderate	Resolved	Network	Network	Fred Luddy	2026-08-19 03:42:45	admin
	INC0010003	2026-08-19 03:14:55	Microsoft Outlook fails to open on employee laptop	Alissa Mountjoy	3 - Moderate	Resolved	Software	Help Desk	(empty)	2026-08-19 03:26:04	admin
	INC0010002	2026-08-19 02:56:21	Employee account locked after multiple failed login attempts	Aileen Mottern	4 - Low	Resolved	Password Reset	Help Desk	(empty)	2026-08-19 03:14:16	admin
	INC0010001	2026-08-14 12:35:50	Unable to connect to corporate VPN	Abel Tutor	4 - Low	Resolved	Network	Network	David Loo	2026-08-18 15:19:46	admin

Figure 1. Incident list demonstrating multiple support scenarios across Network, Password Reset, Software, and Hardware categories, with priority, state, assignment group, assignee, and update information.

11.2 VPN Incident Details

Incident
INC0010001

Discuss Follow Update Close Reopen Delete

Number: INC0010001

* Caller: Abel Tutor

Category: Network

Subcategory: VPN

Service:

Service offering:

Configuration item:

* Short description: Unable to connect to corporate VPN

Description: User is working remotely and is unable to connect to the corporate VPN. VPN authentication fails when attempting to sign in. The user's internet connection is working normally. VPN access is required to access internal company resources.

Channel: Phone

State: Resolved

Impact: 3 - Low

Urgency: 2 - Medium

Priority: 4 - Low

Assignment group: Network

Assigned to: David Loo

Figure 2. VPN support incident showing caller information, Network/VPN categorization, impact and urgency assessment, calculated priority, assignment to the Network team, and a clear business-focused description.

11.3 VPN Incident Resolution

Incident
INC0010001

DiscussFollowUpdateCloseReopenDelete

NotesRelated RecordsResolution Information

Knowledge ☐

Resolved bySystem Administrator

* Resolution codeSolution provided

Resolved2026-08-18 15:19:46

* Resolution notesUser cleared the cached VPN credentials and re-authenticated using the current account password. VPN connection was successfully established and access to internal company resources was restored. User confirmed the issue is resolved.

Figure 3. Resolution record documenting the solution provided, resolved-by information, timestamp, and technical resolution notes after cached VPN credentials were cleared and access was restored.

11.4 VPN Troubleshooting Knowledge Article

Home / IT / Security / Troubleshooting Corporate VPN Connection Issues

SubscribedFlag ArticleCreate IncidentEdit

Troubleshooting Corporate VPN Connection Issues

KBO010001 (Review)

☆☆☆☆☆ 0 views

Purpose

This article provides troubleshooting steps for employees who are unable to connect to the corporate VPN. The VPN allows remote users to securely access internal company resources and services.

Symptoms

- Unable to establish a VPN connection.
- VPN connection fails or disconnects.
- User cannot access internal company resources remotely.
- VPN authentication fails when attempting to sign in.

Troubleshooting Steps

- Confirm that the user's internet connection is working correctly.
- Verify that the correct corporate VPN server or VPN profile is selected.
- Confirm that the user is entering the correct username and password.
- Check whether the user's account is locked or the password has expired.
- Disconnect from the VPN and close the VPN client.
- Clear any previously cached VPN credentials if applicable.
- Restart the VPN client and attempt to connect again.
- If the issue continues, restart the user's computer and test the VPN connection again.

Resolution

If the VPN connection is restored, confirm that the user can successfully access the required internal company resources. Document the troubleshooting actions performed and confirm with the user that normal access has been restored.

Escalation

If the issue persists after completing the troubleshooting steps, document all troubleshooting performed and any error messages received. Escalate the incident to the Network Support team for further investigation.

Figure 4. Knowledge article created for recurring corporate VPN connection issues, including purpose, symptoms, structured troubleshooting steps, resolution guidance, and escalation criteria.

11.5 Task SLA - Priority 3 Resolution

Task SLAs (1)

Affected CIs

Impacted Services/CIs

Child Incidents

SLA definition

Search

Actions on selected rows...

Task = INC0010005

☐	SLA definition	Type	Target	Stage	Business time left	Business elapsed time	Business elapsed percentage	Start time	Stop time	
☐	Priority 3 resolution (1 day)	SLA	Resolution	Paused	1 Day	0 Seconds	0%	2026-08-19 03:50:19	(empty)	

Figure 5. Task SLA view demonstrating awareness of the SLA definition, resolution target, stage, business time remaining, elapsed time, percentage, and timing information.

11.6 Reopened and Escalated Outlook Incident

Incidents Number Search											
All > Active = true											
	Number	Opened	Short description	Caller	Priority	State	Category	Assignment group	Assigned to	Updated	Updated by
	INC0010005	2026-08-19 03:43:28	Employee laptop is not connecting to external monitor	Amelia Caputo	3 - Moderate	Resolved	Hardware	Hardware	Beth Anglin	2026-08-19 03:59:24	admin
	INC0010004	2026-08-19 03:29:06	Unable to access internal company website	Andrew Jackson	3 - Moderate	Resolved	Network	Network	Fred Luddy	2026-08-19 03:42:45	admin
	INC0010003	2026-08-19 03:14:55	Microsoft Outlook fails to open on employee laptop	Alissa Mountjoy	3 - Moderate	In Progress	Software	Software	Don Goodliffe	2026-08-19 09:12:54	admin
	INC0010002	2026-08-19 02:56:21	Employee account locked after multiple failed login attempts	Aileen Mottern	4 - Low	Resolved	Password Reset	Help Desk	(empty)	2026-08-19 03:14:16	admin
	INC0010001	2026-08-14 12:35:50	Unable to connect to corporate VPN	Abel Tuter	4 - Low	Resolved	Network	Network	David Loo	2026-08-18 15:19:46	admin

Figure 6. Previously resolved Outlook incident reopened after the issue returned, moved back to In Progress, reassigned to Software support, and assigned to a specialist for further investigation.

Incident INCO010003

Number	INCO010003	Channel	Email
* Caller	Alissa Mountjoy	State	In Progress
Category	Software	Impact	2 - Medium
Subcategory	Email	Urgency	2 - Medium
Service		Priority	3 - Moderate
Service offering		Assignment group	Software
Configuration item		Assigned to	Don Goodliffe
* Short description	Microsoft Outlook fails to open on employee laptop		
Description	User reports that Microsoft Outlook fails to open the company laptop. Other applications are functioning normally and the internet connection is working. The user requires Outlook to access business email and continue daily work.		

[Related Search Results >](#)

Notes Related Records Resolution Information

Knowledge	☐	Resolved by	
Resolution code	-- None --	Resolved	
Resolution notes			

Figure 7. Internal work notes documenting why the recurring Outlook issue was escalated from the Help Desk to Software support and identifying the next investigation owner.

11.8 Incidents by Category Report

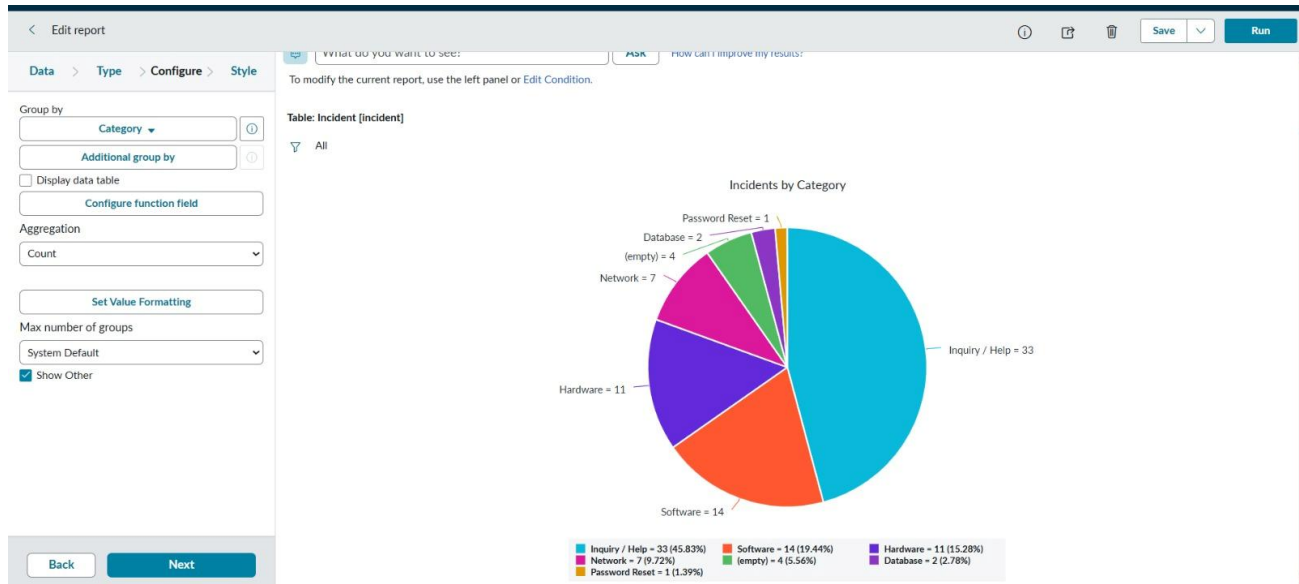


Figure 8. ServiceNow report grouped by incident category, demonstrating aggregation and visual analysis of incident distribution.

11.9 Incidents by Priority Report

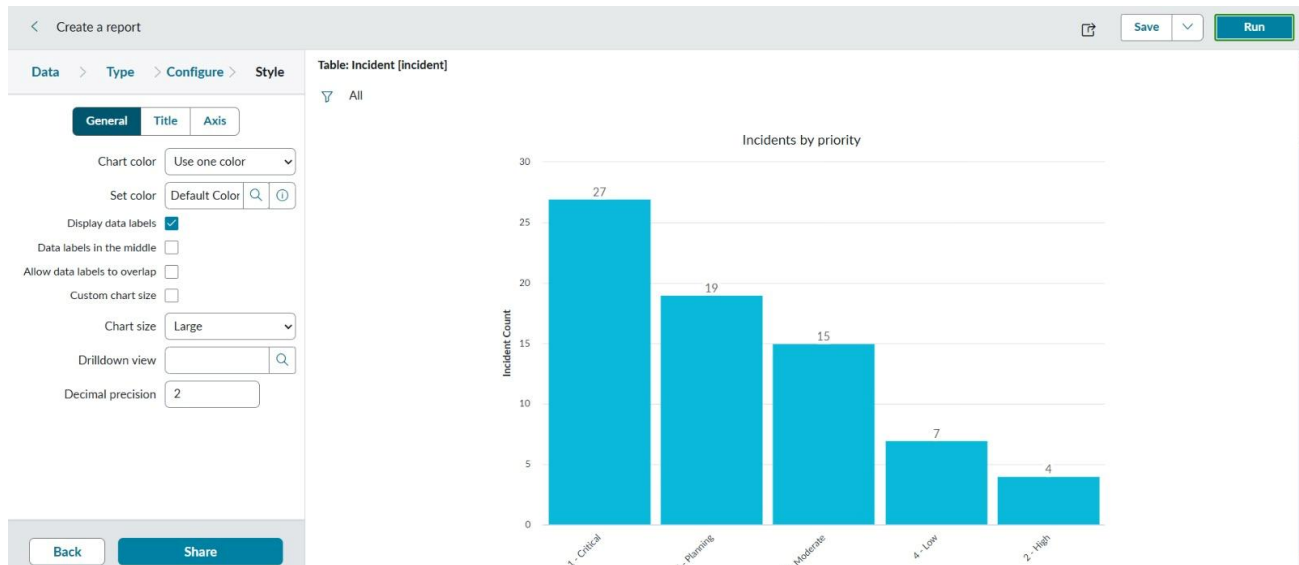


Figure 9. Bar report showing incident counts grouped by priority, supporting operational analysis and prioritization awareness.

11.10 Incidents by State Report

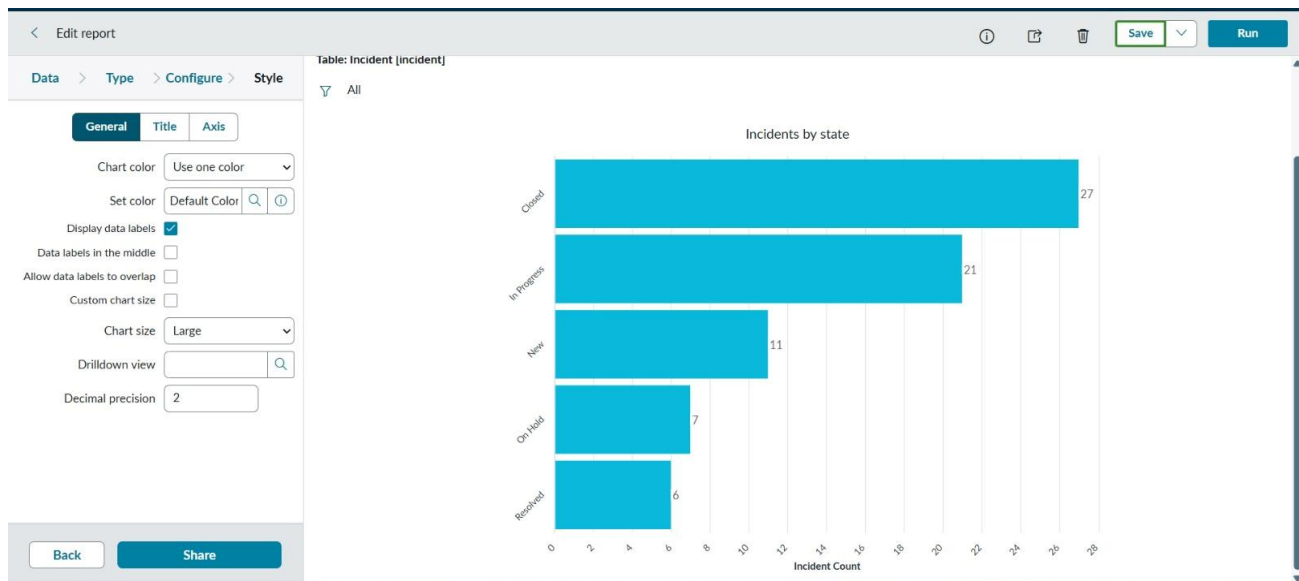


Figure 10. Bar report showing incident counts by lifecycle state, including Closed, In Progress, New, On Hold, and Resolved.

12. Conclusion

This ServiceNow ITSM Incident Management & Service Operations Lab provided practical experience with core IT service management processes in a simulated support environment. The project covered the complete incident lifecycle, including incident creation, categorization, impact and urgency assessment, prioritization, assignment, troubleshooting, resolution, reopening, reassignment, and escalation.

The lab also extended beyond basic incident handling by incorporating SLA tracking, internal work-note documentation, customer communication, knowledge management, and operational reporting. A structured VPN troubleshooting knowledge article was created to demonstrate reusable technical documentation, while reports by category, priority, and state demonstrated the use of ServiceNow data for service-management analysis.

Overall, the project demonstrates practical familiarity with ServiceNow ITSM workflows and an understanding of how service desk and support teams manage, document, escalate, monitor, and analyze incidents in an organized IT environment.